
JoshTurknett.com

Design & Content Specification

1. Purpose of the Site

The site exists to:

1. Present a **coherent intellectual identity**
2. Promote **live engagements** (speaking and workshops)
3. Support credibility through **books and music**
4. Provide a clear path for **high-intent inquiries**

It is not:

- a funnel
- a blog
- a portfolio archive
- a personality brand

It is a **front door**.

2. Core Idea

The site is organized around a single claim:

The power of the human brain is far greater than most people realize.

All content should either:

- explain that claim,
- demonstrate it, or
- support the credibility of making it.

Avoid secondary themes that compete with this.

3. Tone & Voice

The site should sound like:

- an intelligent person thinking clearly in public
- confident without being promotional
- precise rather than evocative
- serious but not academic
- human without being sentimental

Avoid:

- motivational language
- branding slogans
- rhetorical templates
- contrast formulas (“not this, but that”)
- sales language

If a sentence feels like persuasion rather than explanation, rewrite it.

4. Navigation Structure

Top-level navigation:

- Home
- Speaking
- Music
- Books
- About
- Contact

No dropdowns.

No “Events.”

No “Services.”

Each category has a distinct conceptual purpose.

5. Page-by-Page Content Scope

Home

Purpose:

Orientation and framing.

The home page should answer:

- Who is this?
- What is the central idea?
- Why should I care?
- Where do I go next?

Includes:

- A clear, assertive headline expressing the core idea
- A brief introduction establishing identity and scope
- A preview of the Speaking work (linking to Speaking)
- A preview of Books (linking to Books)
- A preview of Music (linking to Music)
- A closing statement reinforcing the core claim

Does not include:

- detailed offerings
- long credentials
- full explanations
- lists of projects

The home page is intentionally incomplete.

Speaking

Purpose:

Primary page for live engagement inquiries.

Conceptual framing:

- One core talk
- Stable intellectual structure
- Tailored emphasis by audience
- Delivered as keynotes, workshops, or extended sessions

Includes:

- The existing speaking copy (unchanged)
- Clarification of formats (keynote, workshop, extended)
- Explanation of audience tailoring (corporate, education, general)
- Clear inquiry path

Music:

- Presented as integral to the talk
- Not optional
- Not positioned as entertainment

Avoid:

- lists of outcomes
 - testimonial blocks
 - pricing
 - hype language
-

Music**Purpose:**

Present music as applied thinking, not as a side project.

Includes:

- Brief framing of music as a laboratory for learning and creativity
- Performance projects (Wandering South, Chillgrass Project, Georgia Jays)
- Music instruction workshops for adult learners
- Explanation of the Brainjo method as applied learning science
- Statement that music, instruction, and speaking can be combined in live contexts

Does not include:

- exhaustive discographies
- song lists
- media overload

Music supports the core idea rather than competing with it.

Books

Purpose:

Promote two specific books, with a clear hierarchy.

Primary:

- *Anyone Can Play Music*

Secondary:

- *The Genius and the Impostor* (Aug 2026)

Tertiary (brief mention only):

- *The Migraine Miracle*
- *Keto for Migraine*

Includes:

- Explanation of what each primary book argues
- How each fits into the larger intellectual arc
- Minimal, restrained calls to action

Avoid:

- blurbs
 - endorsements
 - reviews
 - sales copy
-

About**Purpose:**

Establish trust through coherence, not self-promotion.

Includes:

- Neurologist and researcher background
- Work in cognitive disorders and dementia
- Clinical experience
- Development of large-scale adult learning systems (Brainjo)
- Writing and music as extensions of the same inquiry
- Mention of podcasts and Substacks as ongoing work

Tone:

- narrative
- factual
- restrained

No origin-story dramatization.

Contact

Purpose:

Enable serious inquiries.

Includes:

- Short introductory sentence
- Embedded inquiry form
- No alternative contact clutter

Form supports:

- Speaking
 - Workshops
 - Music instruction
 - Integrated live experiences
-

6. Calls to Action (CTAs)

CTAs should signal **availability**, not urgency.

Preferred language:

- Inquire about speaking
- Speaking inquiries
- Request information
- Contact for speaking or workshops

Avoid:

- Book now
- Get started
- Call today

CTAs may appear:

- once near the top (quietly)
- once after the Speaking content
- once at the bottom

No repetition for pressure.

7. Visual Design Principles

Overall

- Minimal
- Calm
- Serious
- Human

The design should get out of the way of the thinking.

Imagery

Use:

- real photographs
- speaking with instrument visible
- teaching or performing
- candid moments

Avoid:

- stock photography
- abstract “brain” or “AI” imagery
- overly staged marketing visuals

Typography

- Readable
- Neutral
- Slightly literary rather than corporate
- No trendy display fonts

Color

- Restrained palette
- Neutral base

- One accent color at most
-

8. Content Constraints

- Fewer words are better than more words
- Specific claims > general statements
- Explanations > inspiration
- Precision > persuasion

If something feels like it's trying to impress, remove it.

9. What Success Looks Like

A visitor should leave thinking:

“This person is serious.
These ideas are considered.
This would be worth bringing to our organization.”

Not:

- “That was motivating”
 - “That was slick”
 - “That was well branded”
-